

As you're doing this, if you let the cursor stay on the axis for a second, SketchUp will tell you which axis you're on.

2.2.4 Locking Lines On Axes

When you're drawing a line on an axis, there's always the risk that, while you're dragging the mouse along it, you may deviate off that particular axis. To ensure that this does not happen, SketchUp allows you to lock the direction on that axis.

Locking is as easy as turning a key. Only, in this case, you hold down the shift button. The process is explained below:

- Select the line tool.
- Click on the spot on the axis along which you want the line.
- Hold down [Shift]. Instantly you will find that the line which you draw gets thicker, while maintaining the same colour as the axis on which you are drawing.

Now if you drag the mouse around the drawing area, you'll see a dotted line that connects the cursor, constantly, (as long as you're holding down [Shift]), and the ToolTip which says *Constrained on Line*. In short, the line is now locked on to the axis you have chosen and irrespective of where your mouse roams, the line will only form on that very axis.

- Drag the cursor till the point which you want the line to extend and click again. The line will be formed.



Holding down [Shift] keeps the line constrained in a particular direction

2.2.5 Fiddling with Line Entities

Once you've drawn a line, you can play around with it, make changes, edit, split, or divide it into equal line segments, if you so please.